MR. JUSTICE WHITE delivered the opinion of the Court.

Section 8 (a) of the Occupational Safety and Health Act of 1970 (OSHA or Act) [1] empowers agents of the Secretary of Labor (Secretary) to search the work area of any employment facility within the Act's jurisdiction. The purpose of the search is to inspect for safety hazards and violations of OSHA regulations. No search warrant or other process is expressly required under the Act.

On the morning of September 11, 1975, an OSHA inspector entered the customer service area of Barlow's, Inc., an electrical and plumbing installation business located in Pocatello, Idaho. The president and general manager, Ferrol G. "Bill" Barlow, was on hand; and the OSHA inspector, after showing his credentials,[2] informed Mr. Barlow that he wished to con-

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*Semler, Stephen C. Yohay, Leonard J. Theberge, Edward H. Dowd,* and *James Watt* for the Mountain States Legal Foundation; by *James D. McKevitt* for the National Federation of Independent Business; and by *Ronald A. Zumbrun, John H. Findley, Albert Ferri, Jr.,* and *W. Hugh O'Riordan* for the Pacific Legal Foundation.

Briefs of *amici curiae* were filed by *Robert E. Rader, Jr.,* for the American Conservative Union; and by *David Goldberger, Barbara O'Toole, McNeill Stokes, Ira J. Smotherman, Jr.,* and *David Rudenstine* for the Roger Baldwin Foundation, Inc., of the American Civil Liberties Union, Illinois Division.

[1] "In order to carry out the purposes of this chapter, the Secretary, upon presenting appropriate credentials to the owner, operator, or agent in charge, is authorized—

"(1) to enter without delay and at reasonable times any factory, plant, establishment, construction site, or other area, workplace or environment where work is performed by an employee of an employer; and

"(2) to inspect and investigate during regular working hours and at other reasonable times, and within reasonable limits and in a reasonable manner, any such place of employment and all pertinent conditions, structures, machines, apparatus, devices, equipment, and materials therein, and to question privately any such employer, owner, operator, agent, or employee." 84 Stat. 1598, 29 U. S. C. § 657 (a).

[2] This is required by the Act. See n. 1, *supra.*